Metacom Foundation | Bursary Application Form

All information is treated as strictly confidential

PERSONAL INFORMATION OF APPLICANT

SURNAME	Dhladhla	FIRST NAME(S)	Fanelesibonge
INITIALS	F	PREFERRED NAME	Fanelesibonge
DATE OF BIRTH	19 Septermber 2006	ID NUMBER	0609196651085

CELL PHONE NUMBER	0834327728	EXPECTED GRADUATION YEAR	2027
CURRENT DEGREE	Diploma in ICT: Application Development		
UNIVERSITY	Durban University of Technology	STUDENT NUMBER	22485688
DEGREE DURATION	1	STARTING YEAR	2027
EMAIL ADDRESS	Fanelesibongedhladhla23@gmail.com		
HOME ADDRESS	Oqazwini Area, Kwambonambi 3800		
ADDRESS WHILE STUDYING	47 Mallinson Road, Overport, Durban		

EDUCATION BACKGROUND

SCHOOL ATTENDED	Hluma High School	YEAR GRADUATED	2023

Have you received or applied for financial aid before? If yes, please explain why it ended or was not approved.

Yes, It is going to end this year as this is my final year Diploma, and next year I will be pursuing the Advanced Diploma which NSFAS does not fund.

Have you previously pursued other studies? If yes, list them and indicate whether completed. If not completed, please explain why.

No After high school. I've only pursued my Diploma in ICT: Application Development

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT & ACHIEVEMENTS

Leadership & Community Involvement | Describe any leadership roles or ways you've contributed to your community (volunteering, mentoring, student organizations).

Outside of my studies, I have taken on private tutoring to support fellow students struggling academically, helping them understand programming concepts, work through assignments, and build confidence in subjects they found difficult. Beyond theory, I also assisted students practically by guiding them through building their own web application projects helping them translate ideas into working systems, troubleshoot errors, and understand why things work the way they do rather than just copying solutions.

This experience taught me that leadership is not always about a title. Sometimes it is about making yourself available to someone who is stuck and walking them through it patiently. Seeing a student submit a project they genuinely built and understood was more rewarding than any grade. I intend to carry that same willingness to uplift those around me into whatever environment I find myself in.

Sport Participation | Have you been involved in any sports or physical activities? Share your role (player, captain, coach, etc.) and what it has taught you.

I have played football for a number of years, primarily as an attacking midfielder before transitioning to left back. Playing in both roles gave me a well-rounded understanding of the game as an attacking midfielder I was responsible for creating opportunities and driving play forward, while left back demanded defensive discipline, positional awareness, and the ability to read the game quickly.

Football taught me things no classroom can fully replicate. Playing in a team means your individual performance directly affects those around you, which builds a strong sense of accountability. Shifting between two very different positions also taught me adaptability the ability to take on a new role, learn its demands quickly, and still perform under pressure. These are qualities I carry into my academic and professional life, where the ability to adjust, collaborate, and stay composed when things are not going to plan matters just as much as technical skill.

Hobbies and other interests | What hobbies, passions, or personal interests do you enjoy outside of your studies?

I am an avid gamer and have been from a young age. Beyond entertainment, gaming has sharpened the skills I use daily strategic thinking, quick decision making, pattern recognition, and staying composed under pressure. Playing games like Call of Duty, where split-second decisions determine outcomes and team coordination is everything, taught me how to analyze situations fast, communicate under pressure, and adapt my strategy when the original plan stops working. These habits translate directly into how I approach technical problem solving when a feature breaks or a deadline tightens, I do not panic, I assess, adapt, and execute.

Watching anime has been a consistent part of how I unwind, but it has given me more than entertainment. Naruto in particular resonated with me deeply a character who starts with nothing, is overlooked by everyone around him, yet through sheer persistence and self-belief becomes someone others look up to. That story shaped how I think about my own journey as a first-generation student

navigating a technical field with limited resources. Setbacks stopped feeling like signs to quit and started feeling like part of the process — which is the mindset I bring into every difficult project or exam.

Reading has given me the habit of thinking deeply rather than rushing through information. Rich Dad Poor Dad by Robert Kiyosaki was a turning point for me not because of the financial advice specifically, but because it fundamentally changed how I think about value, ownership, and building something that works for you rather than just working for others. It pushed me to see my PC building side hustle and my software projects not just as hobbies but as early steps toward something bigger. That shift in mindset is something no lecture taught me.

Details of participation in cultural activities | Have you taken part in cultural activities (music, art, drama, debate, traditional events)? Please describe your involvement and why it's meaningful to you.

I play the piano at my church, which has been one of the most meaningful ways I have contributed to my community outside of academics. Serving as a pianist in a worship setting is not simply about playing notes it requires preparation, reliability, and the ability to perform consistently in front of others while remaining sensitive to the needs of the moment. It taught me discipline, because the congregation depends on you to show up prepared every time without exception. It also taught me humility, because music in that context is not about personal performance but about contributing to something bigger than yourself. Playing the piano has given me an appreciation for precision and practice that carries directly into my technical work both require you to put in the hours quietly before the results show publicly.

FUTURE & MOTIVATION

Motivation Statement | Please explain why you chose your course of study and why you believe you should be considered for a Metacom Foundation bursary.

I chose ICT Application Development because technology has always been the space where my curiosity feels most at home from taking apart computers as a teenager to building full-stack web applications as a student. I did not choose this field because it seemed like a safe career path. I chose it because I genuinely love building things that work, solving problems that seem impossible until suddenly they are not, and learning technologies that did not exist in their current form a few years ago. I believe I should be considered for the Metacom Foundation bursary because I am not a student who simply attends class and submits assignments I go further independently, teaching myself advanced concepts, taking on real projects, tutoring peers, and finding ways to apply what I learn beyond the classroom. Coming from a single-income household where my mother supports five children on a teacher's salary, this bursary would not just help me it would change the trajectory of my entire family.

Plans for the future | What are your goals for the future, and how do you see your studies helping you achieve them?

My goal is to become a software developer who builds systems that solve real, practical problems for people and businesses, not just functional applications, but thoughtful ones that genuinely improve how things work. Beyond employment, I want to eventually build and run my own technology business, drawing on both my software development skills and my experience running a custom PC building side hustle. My studies in ICT Application Development are giving me the technical foundation to make that possible teaching me how to design systems, think logically, write clean code, and work through complex problems methodically. Every project I complete, every bug I debug, and every new technology I teach myself brings me one step closer to the kind of developer and entrepreneur I am working toward becoming. I am not simply studying for a qualification I am building toward something specific.

Additional Information | Any other information that you would like to include to support your application.

FINANCIAL INFORMATION

DETAILS OF OTHER BURSARIES (*this bursary excluded*):

LOANS	N/A	FINANCIAL INSTITUTION	AVAILABLE ANNUALLY	YES	NO
BURSARIES	N/A	NAME N/A	AVAILABLE ANNUALLY	YES	NO
ALTERNATIVE OPTIONS AVAILABLE (e.g., bank loan by parent)					

FAMILY INCOME & DEPENDENTS

SOURCES OF INCOME

INFORMATION OF	INITIALS	SURNAME	OCCUPATION	GROSS INCOME p/m
MOTHER	NE	Dhladhla	Teacher	37 963.00

EDUCATIONAL COSTS OF OTHER DEPENDENTS OF INCOME

NUMBER OF FAMILY MEMBERS DEPENDANT ON INCOME	ADULTS	2	TERTIARY	3	SCHOOL	1	PRE-SCHOOL	0

NAME	SCHOOL	AMOUNT	UNIVERSITY	AMOUNT
Senzele Dhladhla		R	Majuba TVET College	R14 400 p.a
Amanda Dhaldhla		R	SANTS Private college	R20 000 p.a
Mbuso Mahlinza	Sbonokuhle high school	R 6 200 p.a		
Fanelesibonge Dhladhla			Durban University of Technology	R 110 000 p.a

BUDGET OF ESTIMATED STUDY COSTS			
INCOME	**RAND**	**EXPENSES**	**RAND**
BURSARIES	108 340	TUITION	41 180
LOANS	0	ACCOMMODATION	50 000
CONTRIBUTION FROM PARENTS	0	MEALS	20 000
OTHER	0	BOOKS	0
		TRANSPORT	7 000
		POCKET MONEY	0
		OTHER (please specify)	0
TOTAL INCOME	108 340	**TOTAL EXPENSES**	127 000

☑ I declare that the information provided is true and correct.

☑ I consent to the use of my data for bursary consideration.

☑ I understand that bursary continuation is subject to academic progress and Foundation rules.

SIGNATURE OF APPLICANT

DATE: 29 September 2026